

MONTAGE ANALYSIS

BY ARYAN KUMAR

ASSIGNMENT 3



| La La Land (2016)

The film utilizes the montage technique as a powerful narrative device to explore the contrast between reality and dreams. The most significant instance is the "Epilogue" montage, a heartbreaking seven-minute sequence that rewrites the entire history of the protagonists. It visualizes a "what-if" scenario where Sebastian joins Mia in Paris, they marry, and have a child, effectively condensing an entire lifetime of unlived happiness into a single musical number.

Earlier in the film, montages are employed to depict the passage of time and relationship growth. The "Summer" montage, for instance, showcases Mia and Sebastian exploring Los Angeles jazz clubs and movie sets. This sequence establishes their deepening bond without the need for dialogue, using music and visual rhythm to convey their falling in love against the vibrant, Technicolor backdrop of the city.



LA LA LAND 2016

genre ROMANCE MUSICAL COMEDY

directed by DAMIEN CHAZELLE

produced by FRED BERGER MARK PLATZ & MORE

starring RYAN GOSLING EMMA STONE

JOHN LEGEND ROSEMARIE DEWITT

| Me Before You (2016)

This film relies heavily on montages to bridge the emotional and physical gap between the two main characters. An important sequence involves Lou shaving Will's beard, which serves as an intimate bonding montage. By removing the physical barrier of his weak appearance, the film visually signifies Will letting his guard down. The camera lingers on their eye contact and gentle touches, accelerating the intimacy of their relationship in a way that dialogue alone could not achieve.

Furthermore, the "Exotic Vacation" montage near the film's climax functions to compress time while expanding the emotional stakes. We see a series of shots Will swimming in the ocean, the couple dining under the stars, and sharing quiet moments on the beach. This sequence serves as a "last hurrah," creating perfect memories for the audience to hold onto before the film's tragic conclusion, effectively contrasting the vitality of life with the inevitability of death.



ME BEFORE YOU 2016

running time 111 MINUTES

directed by THEA SHARROCK

produced by SUE BADEN-POWELL KAREN ROSENFELT ALISON OWEN

starring EMILIA CLARKE SAM CLAFLIN MATTHEW LEWIS

| The Conjuring (2013)

In the horror genre, transforming helplessness into active resistance. The "Investigation Setup" montage is a prime example of this. As the Warrens arrive at the Perron farmhouse, the editing pace quickens. We see rapid cuts of the team taping wires, setting up thermal cameras, testing microphones, and positioning UV flashes. This creates a rhythmic, almost military-like atmosphere of preparation.

This sequence is crucial for establishing authority and credibility. By focusing on the technical aspects of paranormal investigation, the film grounds the supernatural in a sense of realism. It signals to the audience that the characters are competent professionals rather than just victims. The montage builds anticipation, effectively telling the viewer that the "battle" for the house is about to begin, thereby heightening the tension before the scares escalate.



THE CONJURING 2013

running time 1h 52m

directed by JAMES WAN

produced by PETER SAFRAN ROB COWAN TONY DEROSA-GRUND

starring VERA FARMIGA PATRICK WILSON LILI TAYLOR

| P.S. I Love You (2007)

The film employs a unique montage structure where letters trigger flashbacks. Each time Holly opens a letter from her late husband Gerry, the film transitions into a montage of their past life together. These sequences are not just memories; they are active narrative devices that guide Holly through her grief. They show the full spectrum of their relationship, from heated arguments to tender reconciliations, preventing the deceased character from becoming a one-dimensional saint.

A significant atmospheric shift occurs during the "Ireland Trip" montage. As Holly and her friends travel through the lush, green Irish countryside, the visual tone of the movie changes from the claustrophobic, grey interiors of a grieving New York apartment to vast, open landscapes. This montage signifies a turning point in Holly's internal journey, visually representing the "opening up" of her heart and the beginning of her healing process amidst the beauty of nature.



P.S. I LOVE YOU 2007

running time 125 MINUTES

directed by RICHARD LAGRAVENESE

produced by WENDY FINERMAN BRODERICK JOHNSON ANDREW KOSOVE MOLLY SMITH

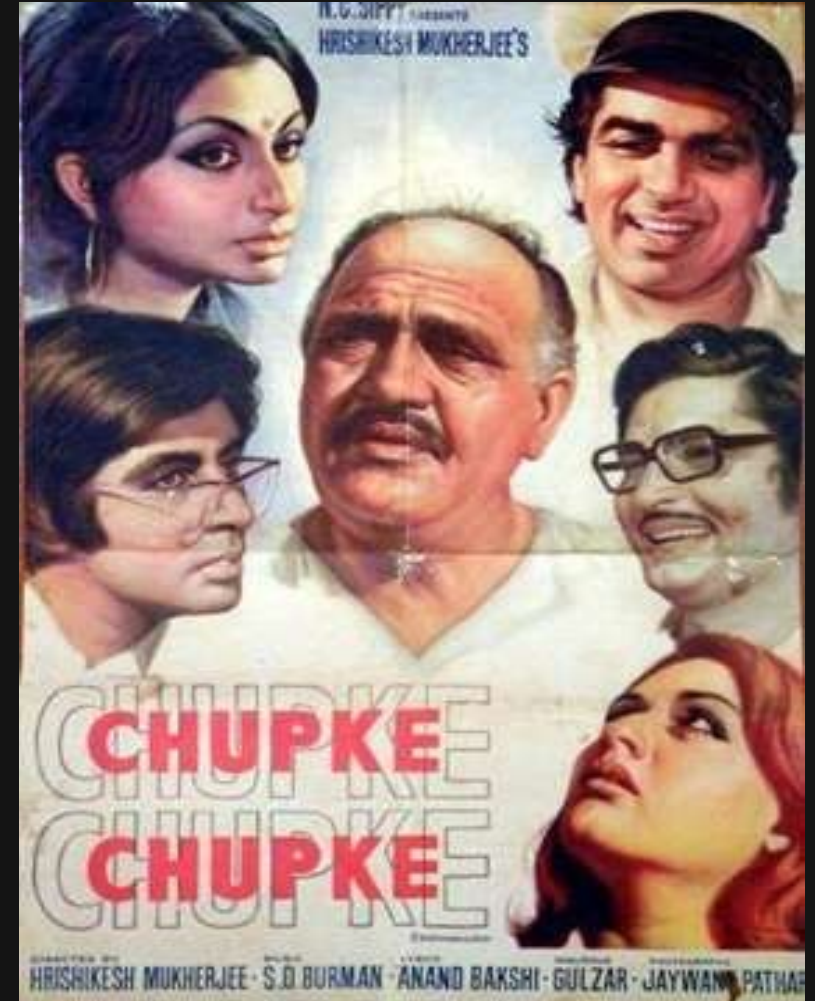
starring HILARY SWANK GERARD BUTLER LISA KUDROW GINA GERSHON JAMES MARSTERS
HARRY CONNICK JR. JEFFREY DEAN MORGAN NELLIE MCKAY KATHY BATES ANNE KENT
BRIAN MCGRATH

| Chupke Chupke (1975)

In classic Bollywood cinema, song sequences frequently function as narrative montages. The "Sa Re Ga Ma" singing lesson is a masterclass in this technique. Ostensibly a music lesson between a driver and a student, the sequence uses the song to depict a blossoming, forbidden romance.

The editing cuts between their secret glances and the oblivious or suspicious reactions of other family members, compressing weeks of developing intimacy into a few minutes.

This montage also serves a comedic purpose through dramatic irony. The audience knows the "driver" is actually a professor and the "student" is his wife, but the on-screen brother-in-law does not. The montage highlights the brother-in-law's growing frustration as he tries to catch them in the act, only to be thwarted by their innocent facade. This use of montage advances the plot, deepens the romance, and heightens the comedy simultaneously.





THANK YOU